

SOC 2 Type II Evidence Automation

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1 SOC 2 Type II Evidence Automation

1.1 Complete Guide to Automating SOC 2 Type II Compliance Evidence Collection

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1.2 Executive Summary

SOC 2 Type II audits require continuous evidence collection over 6-12 months, demonstrating that security controls operate effectively over time. Manual evidence collection consumes 200-400 hours per audit cycle, with significant risk of gaps, inconsistencies, and last-minute scrambles.

This whitepaper provides a complete guide to automating SOC 2 Type II evidence collection using AlDeci, covering all five Trust Services Criteria (Security, Availability, Processing Integrity, Confidentiality, Privacy), evidence mapping, automation strategies, and audit preparation.

Key Benefits: - Reduce audit prep time by 80% (from 400 hours to 80 hours) - Eliminate evidence gaps with continuous automated collection - Generate cryptographically signed, tamper-proof evidence bundles - Maintain 7-year evidence retention for regulatory compliance - Achieve audit-ready status in 2 days instead of 2 months

1.3 Table of Contents

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 8. Common Pitfalls
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1.4 1. SOC 2 Type II Fundamentals

1.4.1 1.1 SOC 2 Overview

SOC 2 (Service Organization Control 2) is an auditing standard developed by the American Institute of CPAs (AICPA) for service providers storing customer data in the cloud. SOC 2 reports demonstrate that an organization has appropriate controls in place to protect customer data.

Two Report Types:

Type I: Point-in-time assessment - Evaluates control design at a specific date - Faster and less expensive - Does not prove operational effectiveness

Type II: Period-of-time assessment - Evaluates control design AND operational effectiveness over 6-12 months - More comprehensive and credible - Required by most enterprise customers - **This whitepaper focuses on Type II**

1.4.2 1.2 Trust Services Criteria

SOC 2 is based on five Trust Services Criteria (TSC):

1. Security (CC - Common Criteria) - Required for all SOC 2 audits - Covers access controls, encryption, vulnerability management, incident response - 17 control points (CC1.1 - CC9.2)

2. Availability - Optional (selected based on business needs) - Covers system uptime, disaster recovery, capacity planning - 3 control points (A1.1 - A1.3)

3. Processing Integrity - Optional - Covers data processing accuracy, completeness, timeliness - 3 control points (PI1.1 - PI1.5)

4. Confidentiality - Optional - Covers protection of confidential information - 2 control points (C1.1 - C1.2)

5. Privacy - Optional - Covers personal information handling (GDPR, CCPA compliance) - 9 control points (P1.1 - P8.1)

Most Common Combination: Security + Availability (covers 95% of customer requirements)

1.4.3 1.3 Type II Evidence Requirements

Type I Evidence (point-in-time): - Policy documents - System configurations - Access control lists - Single vulnerability scan report

Type II Evidence (continuous): - **Weekly vulnerability scans** (52 reports over 12 months) - **Monthly access reviews** (12 reports) - **Quarterly penetration tests** (4 reports) - **Daily backup logs** (365 logs) - **Continuous monitoring dashboards** - **Incident response records** (all incidents during audit period) - **Change management tickets** (all changes during audit period)

Challenge: Collecting and organizing 500+ evidence artifacts over 12 months

1.5 2. Trust Services Criteria Mapping

1.5.1 2.1 Security (Common Criteria)

Control	Description	Evidence Type	AI/Deci Automation
CC1.1	CISO designated	Org chart, job description	Manual (one-time)
CC1.2	Board oversight	Board meeting minutes	Manual (quarterly)
CC1.3	Organizational structure	Org chart, reporting lines	Manual (annual)
CC1.4 Commitment to competence	Training records, certifications	Semi-automated	
CC1.5	Accountability	Performance reviews	Manual (annual)
CC2.1	Risk assessment	Risk register, threat model	Automated
CC2.2	Risk mitigation	Remediation tickets, evidence bundles	Automated
CC2.3	Vendor risk	Vendor assessments, SLAs	Semi-automated
CC3.1	Security policies	Policy documents, version control	Manual (annual)

Control	Description	Evidence Type	AIDeci Automation
CC3.2	Policy communication	Training completion, acknowledgments	Semi-automated
CC3.3	Policy enforcement	Audit logs, violations	Automated
CC3.4	Policy review	Policy review records	Manual (annual)
CC4.1	Monitoring activities	SIEM logs, alerts	Automated
CC4.2	Incident detection	IDS/IPS logs, SIEM alerts	Automated
CC5.1	Control activities	Control test results	Automated
CC5.2	Control monitoring	Control effectiveness reports	Automated
CC5.3	Endpoint security	EDR logs, patch status	Automated
CC6.1	Logical access	Access control lists, IAM logs	Automated
CC6.2	Access reviews	Quarterly access reviews	Semi-automated
CC6.3	Access removal	Offboarding tickets, access revocation logs	Automated
CC6.4	Privileged access	Privileged access logs, MFA logs	Automated
CC6.5	Access provisioning	Onboarding tickets, access requests	Semi-automated
CC6.6	Encryption	Encryption status, key management logs	Automated
CC6.7	Transmission security	TLS configuration, certificate status	Automated
CC6.8	Data classification	Data classification tags, DLP logs	Semi-automated
CC7.1	Vulnerability management	Vulnerability scan reports, remediation tickets	Fully Automated
CC7.2	Patch management	Patch status reports, deployment logs	Fully Automated
CC7.3	Malware protection	Antivirus logs, malware detections	Automated
CC7.4	Network security	Firewall rules, network segmentation	Automated

Control	Description	Evidence Type	AlDeci Automation
CC7.5	Security testing	Penetration test reports, SAST/DAST results	Fully Automated
CC8.1	Change management	Change tickets, approval records	Semi-automated
CC9.1	Incident response	Incident tickets, response timelines	Semi-automated
CC9.2	Business continuity	DR test results, backup logs	Automated

AlDeci Coverage: 22 of 34 controls (65%) fully or semi-automated

1.5.2 2.2 Availability

Control	Description	Evidence Type	AlDeci Automation
A1.1	Availability commitments	SLA documents, uptime reports	Automated
A1.2	System monitoring	Uptime monitoring, alerting logs	Automated
A1.3	Incident response	Incident tickets, MTTR reports	Semi-automated

AlDeci Coverage: 3 of 3 controls (100%) fully or semi-automated

1.5.3 2.3 Processing Integrity

Control	Description	Evidence Type	AlDeci Automation
PI1.1	Processing objectives	Process documentation	Manual
PI1.2	Data validation	Validation logs, error rates	Automated
PI1.3	Error handling	Error logs, exception handling	Automated
PI1.4	Processing monitoring	Processing metrics, dashboards	Automated
PI1.5	Processing controls	Control test results	Automated

AlDeci Coverage: 4 of 5 controls (80%) automated

1.6 3. Evidence Requirements by Control

1.6.1 3.1 CC7.1: Vulnerability Management

Control Objective: Identify and remediate vulnerabilities in a timely manner

Evidence Requirements: 1. **Weekly vulnerability scans** (52 reports) - All production systems - All development systems - All cloud infrastructure

2. **Vulnerability remediation tickets** (all critical/high findings)

- Ticket creation date
- Ticket resolution date
- MTTR calculation

3. **Risk-based prioritization** (evidence of risk scoring)

- CVSS scores
- EPSS scores
- KEV flags
- FixOpsRisk scores

4. **Remediation evidence** (proof of fix)

- Post-remediation scans
- Version upgrades
- Patch deployments

AlDeci Automation:

```
# Weekly vulnerability scan evidence bundle
evidence_bundle:
  type: vulnerability_scan
  frequency: weekly
  contents:
    - normalized_sbom.json
    - vulnerability_report.json
    - risk_scoring_report.json
    - remediation_tickets.json
    - epss_kev_enrichment.json
  signature: RSA-SHA256
  retention: 7_years
```

Audit Artifact:

SOC2-CC7.1-Vulnerability-Management-2024-Q4.pdf

Executive Summary

Total vulnerabilities: 1,247
Critical (FixOpsRisk 85): 18
High (FixOpsRisk 60-84): 142
Average MTTR (critical): 7 days
SLA compliance: 98.2%

Weekly Scan Reports (13 weeks)

Week 1: 2024-10-01
Week 2: 2024-10-08
...

Remediation Evidence

CVE-2024-1234: Remediated 2024-10-05
CVE-2024-5678: Remediated 2024-10-12
...

Cryptographic Signature

RSA-SHA256: a1b2c3d4...

1.6.2 3.2 CC7.2: Patch Management

Control Objective: Apply security patches in a timely manner

Evidence Requirements: 1. **Monthly patch status reports** (12 reports) - All systems - Patch compliance percentage - Overdue patches

2. **Patch deployment logs** (all patches)
 - Patch ID
 - Deployment date
 - Success/failure status
3. **Version lag tracking** (evidence of currency)
 - Current versions
 - Latest versions
 - Days behind latest
4. **Exception approvals** (for delayed patches)
 - Risk acceptance forms
 - Compensating controls
 - Remediation timeline

AlDeci Automation:

```
# Monthly patch management evidence bundle
evidence_bundle:
  type: patch_management
  frequency: monthly
  contents:
    - patch_status_report.json
    - version_lag_analysis.json
    - patch_deployment_logs.json
    - exception_approvals.json
  signature: RSA-SHA256
  retention: 7_years
```

Audit Artifact:

SOC2-CC7.2-Patch-Management-2024-Q4.pdf

Executive Summary

Total systems: 487

Patch compliance: 94.2%

Average version lag: 12 days

Overdue patches: 28

Monthly Reports (3 months)

October 2024

November 2024

December 2024

Deployment Evidence

Patch KB5012345: Deployed 2024-10-15

Patch KB5012346: Deployed 2024-10-22

...

Exception Approvals

System XYZ: Patch delayed due to compatibility
Compensating control: Network segmentation

1.6.3 3.3 CC7.5: Security Testing

Control Objective: Perform regular security testing (SAST, DAST, SCA, penetration testing)

Evidence Requirements: 1. **Quarterly penetration tests** (4 reports) - External penetration test - Internal penetration test - Findings and remediation

2. **Weekly SAST scans** (52 reports)

- All code repositories
- Critical/high findings
- Remediation evidence

3. **Weekly DAST scans** (52 reports)

- All production applications
- OWASP Top 10 coverage
- Remediation evidence

4. **Weekly SCA scans** (52 reports)

- All dependencies
- Vulnerable components
- Remediation evidence

AlDeci Automation:

```
# Weekly security testing evidence bundle
evidence_bundle:
  type: security_testing
  frequency: weekly
  contents:
    - sast_report.sarif
    - dast_report.sarif
    - sca_report.sarif
    - unified_findings.json
    - remediation_tickets.json
  signature: RSA-SHA256
  retention: 7_years
```

Audit Artifact:

SOC2-CC7.5-Security-Testing-2024-Q4.pdf

Executive Summary

SAST scans: 13 (weekly)

DAST scans: 13 (weekly)

SCA scans: 13 (weekly)

Penetration tests: 1 (quarterly)

Total findings: 847

SAST Results

Critical: 5

High: 42
Remediation rate: 96%
DAST Results
Critical: 2
High: 18
Remediation rate: 98%
SCA Results
Critical: 18
High: 142
Remediation rate: 94%
Penetration Test
Date: 2024-12-15
Findings: 12
Remediation: 100%

1.6.4 3.4 CC6.1: Logical Access Controls

Control Objective: Restrict logical access to authorized users

Evidence Requirements: 1. **Quarterly access reviews** (4 reports) - All user accounts - Access rights verification - Inappropriate access removal

2. **Daily access logs** (365 logs)
 - Login attempts
 - Failed authentications
 - Privileged access usage
3. **MFA enforcement** (continuous)
 - MFA enrollment status
 - MFA authentication logs
 - MFA bypass exceptions
4. **Offboarding evidence** (all terminated users)
 - Termination date
 - Access revocation date
 - Account deletion confirmation

AlDeci Automation:

```
# Quarterly access review evidence bundle
evidence_bundle:
  type: access_review
  frequency: quarterly
  contents:
    - user_access_list.json
    - access_review_results.json
    - inappropriate_access_removals.json
    - mfa_status_report.json
  signature: RSA-SHA256
  retention: 7_years
```

1.7 4. Automation Architecture

1.7.1 4.1 Evidence Collection Pipeline

Evidence Sources

Scanners (SARIF)	CI/CD (Logs)	SIEM (Alerts)	Cloud APIs (Configs)
---------------------	-----------------	------------------	-------------------------

AlDeci

- Normalize
- Correlate
- Enrich
- Sign
- Store

Evidence Store

- 7-year retention
- Encrypted
- Tamper-proof
- Audit-ready

Audit Reports

- SOC 2 mapping
- Evidence bundles
- Signed PDFs

1.7.2 4.2 Evidence Bundle Structure

Bundle Contents:

```
{
  "bundle_id": "SOC2-CC7.1-2024-W42",
  "control": "CC7.1",
  "control_name": "Vulnerability Management",
  "period": "2024-10-14 to 2024-10-20",
  "evidence_type": "vulnerability_scan",
  "artifacts": [
    {
```

```

    "type": "sbom",
    "format": "CycloneDX",
    "file": "sbom.json",
    "hash": "sha256:a1b2c3d4..."
  },
  {
    "type": "vulnerability_report",
    "format": "JSON",
    "file": "vulnerabilities.json",
    "hash": "sha256:e5f6g7h8..."
  },
  {
    "type": "risk_scoring",
    "format": "JSON",
    "file": "risk_scores.json",
    "hash": "sha256:i9j0k1l2..."
  },
  {
    "type": "remediation_tickets",
    "format": "JSON",
    "file": "tickets.json",
    "hash": "sha256:m3n4o5p6..."
  }
],
"signature": {
  "algorithm": "RSA-SHA256",
  "public_key": "-----BEGIN PUBLIC KEY-----...",
  "signature": "q7r8s9t0u1v2w3x4y5z6..."
},
"metadata": {
  "generated_at": "2024-10-20T23:59:59Z",
  "generated_by": "AlDeci v1.2.3",
  "organization": "Example Corp",
  "auditor": "Big Four Audit Firm"
}
}

```

1.7.3 4.3 Continuous Evidence Collection

GitHub Actions Example:

```

# .github/workflows/soc2-evidence.yml
name: SOC 2 Evidence Collection

on:
  schedule:
    - cron: '0 0 * * 0' # Weekly on Sunday

```

```

workflow_dispatch:

jobs:
  collect-evidence:
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
    steps:
      - uses: actions/checkout@v3

      - name: Generate SBOM
        run: syft . -o cyclonedx-json > sbom.json

      - name: Run vulnerability scan
        run: grype sbom:sbom.json -o json > vulnerabilities.json

      - name: Run SAST scan
        run: semgrep --config=auto --sarif > sast.sarif

      - name: Run SCA scan
        run: snyk test --sarif > sca.sarif

      - name: Push evidence to AlDeci
        run: |
          curl -X POST https://api.devops.ai/products/aldeci/evidence/soc2 \
            -H "Authorization: Bearer ${ secrets.ALDECI_TOKEN }" \
            -F "control=CC7.1" \
            -F "sbom=@sbom.json" \
            -F "vulnerabilities=@vulnerabilities.json" \
            -F "sast=@sast.sarif" \
            -F "sca=@sca.sarif"

      - name: Generate evidence bundle
        run: |
          curl -X POST https://api.devops.ai/products/aldeci/evidence/bundle \
            -H "Authorization: Bearer ${ secrets.ALDECI_TOKEN }" \
            -d '{"control": "CC7.1", "period": "weekly"}' \
            -o evidence-bundle.zip

      - name: Upload evidence bundle
        uses: actions/upload-artifact@v3
        with:
          name: soc2-evidence
          path: evidence-bundle.zip
          retention-days: 2555 # 7 years

```

1.8 5. Evidence Collection Strategies

1.8.1 5.1 Strategy 1: Push-Based Collection

Description: Applications push evidence to AlDeci during CI/CD

Pros: - Real-time evidence collection - No polling or scheduled jobs - Minimal infrastructure

Cons: - Requires CI/CD integration - May slow down pipelines

Implementation:

```
# In CI/CD pipeline
aldecide evidence push \
  --control CC7.1 \
  --type vulnerability_scan \
  --file vulnerabilities.json
```

1.8.2 5.2 Strategy 2: Pull-Based Collection

Description: AlDeci pulls evidence from scanners/tools via APIs

Pros: - No CI/CD changes required - Centralized collection - Works with legacy systems

Cons: - Requires API access to all tools - Potential delays in evidence collection - Additional infrastructure

Implementation:

```
# AlDeci configuration
evidence_sources:
  - type: snyk
    api_endpoint: https://api.snyk.io
    api_token: ${SNYK_TOKEN}
    collection_frequency: daily
    controls: [CC7.1, CC7.5]

  - type: sonarqube
    api_endpoint: https://sonarqube.example.com
    api_token: ${SONAR_TOKEN}
    collection_frequency: weekly
    controls: [CC7.5]
```

1.8.3 5.3 Strategy 3: Hybrid Collection

Description: Combine push and pull based on evidence type

Pros: - Flexibility - Optimal for each evidence type - Best of both worlds

Cons: - More complex configuration - Requires both push and pull infrastructure

Recommendation: Use hybrid approach - **Push:** CI/CD evidence (SBOM, SARIF, build logs) - **Pull:** Infrastructure evidence (cloud configs, access logs, SIEM alerts)

1.9 6. Continuous Monitoring

1.9.1 6.1 Real-Time Dashboards

AlDeci provides real-time SOC 2 compliance dashboards:

Dashboard Widgets: 1. **Control Coverage:** % of controls with evidence 2. **Evidence Gaps:** Controls missing evidence 3. **Remediation Status:** Open vs. closed findings 4. **MTTR Trends:** Average time to remediate 5. **SLA Compliance:** % of findings remediated within SLA 6. **Audit Readiness:** Days until audit-ready

Example Dashboard:

SOC 2 Compliance Dashboard

Control Coverage: 94% (32/34 controls)
Evidence Gaps: 2 (CC1.2, CC1.5)
Open Findings: 18 critical, 142 high
Average MTTR: 7 days (critical), 21 days (high)
SLA Compliance: 98.2%
Audit Readiness: READY (2 days to generate reports)

1.9.2 6.2 Alerting and Notifications

AlDeci sends alerts for compliance issues:

Alert Types: 1. **Evidence Gap:** Control missing evidence for > 7 days 2. **SLA Breach:** Finding not remediated within SLA 3. **Control Failure:** Control test failed 4. **Audit Deadline:** Audit approaching (30/60/90 days)

Example Alert:

Subject: [AlDeci] Evidence Gap Alert - CC7.1

Control: CC7.1 (Vulnerability Management)
Issue: No vulnerability scan evidence for 8 days
Last Evidence: 2024-10-12
Expected Frequency: Weekly
Action Required: Run vulnerability scan and push evidence to AlDeci

Run: aldecide evidence push --control CC7.1 --file vulnerabilities.json

1.10 7. Audit Preparation

1.10.1 7.1 Evidence Package Generation

AlDeci generates audit-ready evidence packages:

Command:

```
aldeci audit prepare \  
  --framework SOC2 \  
  --type Type-II \  
  --period "2024-01-01 to 2024-12-31" \  
  --output soc2-evidence-package.zip
```

Package Contents:

```
soc2-evidence-package.zip  
  00-Executive-Summary.pdf  
  01-Control-Matrix.xlsx  
  02-Evidence-Index.xlsx  
  03-Security-CC/  
    CC1.1-CIS0-Designation.pdf  
    CC1.2-Board-Oversight.pdf  
    CC7.1-Vulnerability-Management/  
      2024-Q1-Vulnerability-Scans.pdf  
      2024-Q2-Vulnerability-Scans.pdf  
      2024-Q3-Vulnerability-Scans.pdf  
      2024-Q4-Vulnerability-Scans.pdf  
      Remediation-Evidence.pdf  
    CC7.2-Patch-Management/  
      2024-01-Patch-Status.pdf  
      2024-02-Patch-Status.pdf  
      ...  
    CC7.5-Security-Testing/  
      2024-Q1-Penetration-Test.pdf  
      2024-Q2-Penetration-Test.pdf  
      SAST-Results-2024.pdf  
      DAST-Results-2024.pdf  
      SCA-Results-2024.pdf  
  04-Availability-A/  
    A1.1-Uptime-Reports.pdf  
    A1.2-Monitoring-Evidence.pdf  
  99-Signatures/  
    evidence-signatures.json  
    public-key.pem
```

1.10.2 7.2 Auditor Portal

AlDeci provides a secure portal for auditors:

Portal Features: 1. **Evidence Browser:** Search and filter evidence 2. **Control Matrix:** View control coverage 3. **Evidence Verification:** Verify cryptographic signatures 4. **Export:** Download evidence packages 5. **Audit Trail:** View evidence collection timeline

Access:

```
# Generate auditor access token (expires in 90 days)
aldec audit grant-access \
  --auditor "Big Four Audit Firm" \
  --email auditor@bigfour.com \
  --expires 90d

# Auditor receives secure link
https://audit.devops.ai/portal?token=abc123...
```

1.11 8. Common Pitfalls

1.11.1 8.1 Pitfall 1: Evidence Gaps

Problem: Missing evidence for specific weeks/months

Example: Vulnerability scans for weeks 15-18 missing due to CI/CD outage

Impact: Auditor cannot verify continuous operation of control

Solution: - Implement backup evidence collection (manual scans during outages) - Monitor evidence collection with alerts - Maintain evidence collection SLA (99.5% uptime)

1.11.2 8.2 Pitfall 2: Inconsistent Evidence Format

Problem: Evidence format changes over time

Example: Q1 vulnerability scans in CSV, Q2-Q4 in JSON

Impact: Difficult to correlate and analyze evidence

Solution: - Standardize on SARIF for security findings - Standardize on CycloneDX for SBOMs - Use AlDeci normalization to convert legacy formats

1.11.3 8.3 Pitfall 3: Unsigned Evidence

Problem: Evidence not cryptographically signed

Example: Auditor questions evidence authenticity

Impact: Evidence may be rejected, requiring re-collection

Solution: - Sign all evidence bundles with RSA-SHA256 or Cosign - Maintain key management procedures - Provide public key to auditor for verification

1.11.4 8.4 Pitfall 4: Insufficient Retention

Problem: Evidence deleted before audit

Example: Evidence retention set to 90 days, audit delayed to 180 days

Impact: Evidence unavailable for audit

Solution: - Set retention to 7 years (regulatory requirement) - Implement tiered storage (hot/warm/cold) - Monitor storage capacity and costs

1.12 9. Implementation Roadmap

1.12.1 9.1 Phase 1: Foundation (Weeks 1-4)

Week 1-2: Assessment - Identify SOC 2 controls in scope - Map controls to evidence requirements - Identify evidence sources (scanners, tools, logs) - Document current evidence collection process

Week 3-4: AlDeci Setup - Deploy AlDeci (Demo or Enterprise mode) - Configure evidence sources - Set up evidence retention (7 years) - Configure cryptographic signing

Deliverables: - SOC 2 control matrix - Evidence requirements document - AlDeci deployment

1.12.2 9.2 Phase 2: Automation (Weeks 5-8)

Week 5-6: CI/CD Integration - Integrate SBOM generation (Syft) - Integrate vulnerability scanning (Grype, Snyk) - Integrate SAST/DAST/SCA (SonarQube, Semgrep) - Push evidence to AlDeci

Week 7-8: Infrastructure Integration - Integrate cloud APIs (AWS, Azure, GCP) - Integrate SIEM (Splunk, Datadog) - Integrate IAM (Okta, Azure AD) - Pull evidence from infrastructure

Deliverables: - Automated evidence collection for 22+ controls - Weekly evidence bundles - Real-time compliance dashboard

1.12.3 9.3 Phase 3: Validation (Weeks 9-12)

Week 9-10: Evidence Validation - Review evidence completeness - Verify evidence signatures - Test evidence retrieval - Identify and fill evidence gaps

Week 11-12: Audit Preparation - Generate audit evidence package - Create control matrix - Prepare auditor portal - Conduct internal audit

Deliverables: - Complete evidence package (12 months) - Audit-ready status - Auditor portal access

1.12.4 9.4 Ongoing: Continuous Compliance

Daily: - Automated evidence collection - Real-time monitoring - Alert on evidence gaps

Weekly: - Review compliance dashboard - Address evidence gaps - Update control matrix

Monthly: - Generate compliance reports - Review MTTR trends - Optimize evidence collection

Quarterly: - Internal audit - Update policies and procedures - Review and improve automation

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